

Help through Entrepreneurship and Livelihood Skills Project

HEALS 2.0

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RATIONALE

Capiz State University as a higher institution plays a vital role in rural development. It has been a partner of the different Municipalities in the Province of Capiz, in organizing cooperatives, communities and projects. It has also been instrumental in seeking recognition and funding of these organizations from various funding institutions. Help, assistance and disseminated technologies are channeled through these organizations to be distributed to their members. Through these associations/cooperatives the sense of responsibilities and belonging of the farmers, residents and other stakeholders are boosted and their bargaining power is increased. The individualistic approach was abolished towards a functional teamwork.

COVID-19 has severely affected the global economy and financial markets. Significant reductions in income, a rise in unemployment, and disruptions in the transportation, service, and manufacturing industries are among the consequences of the disease mitigation measures that have been implemented in many countries. As disease outbreaks are not likely to disappear yet, proactive international actions are required to not only save lives but also protect economic prosperity.

Esperanza Livelihood Association, Caridad Livelihood Association, Milan Livelihood Association and Jaena Norte in the Municipality of Jamindan were greatly affected not only due to pandemic but because of mismanagement and lack of knowledge on business operations.

In order to serve and improve these associations, the College of Management Extension Department of Capiz State University Burias Campus offers a wide variety of extension programs and services. These are designed primarily to promote, support and sustain human development, increase the security of livelihood, and alleviate poverty.

This project was based on the result of the research conducted entitled "*Effectiveness of Sustainable Livelihood Program in the Municipality of Jamindan*" and the needs asserted by the Local Government Unit of Jamindan. For them, it is about time to make initiatives and asked help from other people.



The CAPSU Burias College of Management conducts needs assessment analysis in order to identify what assistance and support they can offer to the stakeholders in the Municipality of Jamindan.

OBJECTIVES OF THE PROJECT

1. Develop business management skills among officers and members of the different associations under Sustainable Livelihood Program (SLP) DSWD in the Municipality of Jamindan;
2. Train the participants in terms of:
 - Business management and strategies
 - Duties and Responsibilities of Officers and Members of the Association
 - Basic Bookkeeping
 - Recordkeeping; and
3. Assist the association in organizing a lending institution.

The College of Management and the Municipality of Jamindan plan out their extension activities after conducting the needs analysis and discovering the results based on the study entitled *“Effectiveness of Sustainable Livelihood Program in the Municipality of Jamindan”*



PROJECT DESCRIPTION

Prior to the conceptualization of the project, on April 3, 2021 the officials of the Municipality of Jamindan sought the assistance of Capiz State University-Burias Campus to extend its help by utilizing the expertise of its faculty. They requested the Campus to conduct trainings on Business Management and Entrepreneurship so as to improve their entrepreneurship skills and to promote good relationship among their constituents.

Having expressed the needs of the Local Government Unit of Jamindan headed by Municipal Mayor Mac Artur Valdemar and the Municipal Social Welfare Development Officer Mrs. Milagros Robles, CAPSU Burias then requested the expertise of the College of Management since it offers degrees such as Bachelor of Science in Business Administration, majors in Financial Management and Marketing Management. They immediately heed the call for help.

As a response to the needs of the LGU Officials and MSWDO personnel, the Help through Entrepreneurship and Livelihood Skills Extension Project of the College of Management of CAPSU Burias started to exist. One of the major components of the said project is to develop the entrepreneurial skills among residents of Barangay Esperanza, Caridad, Milan and Jaena Norte and help them identify the livelihood/business opportunities in the locality. In order to achieve this, the faculty and staff of the College conducted the **'Business Management and Entrepreneurship Training Program'** which was participated by the officers and members of the mentioned associations.

During the conduct of the training program, the following topics were discussed thoroughly by the faculty of the College: "Qualities, Attributes and Characteristics of an entrepreneur"; "Starting a Business"; "Identifying Business Opportunities in Barangay Esperanza and Caridad"; "Business Management and Strategies"; and "Accounting and Record Keeping".

In order to monitor the sustainability of the said program and to find out if the knowledge and skills transfer to the recipients are put into practice, the Extension Coordinator of the CM conducts quarter monitoring by attending the Barangay Officials and Association's regular meeting. Moreover, a sustainability plan was created.

RESULTS OF THE INTERVENTION

To find out if the conduct of the “Entrepreneurship and Livelihood Skills Training Program” has derived positive effects, quarterly monitoring is conducted. The following are the observed results:

1. Enhanced business management skills among Officers and members of Esperanza, Caridad, Milan, and Jaena Norte Livelihood Associations.
2. With the assistance of College of Management of CAPSU Burias Campus, the officers and members of the associations were:
 - equipped with right knowledge on business management and strategies;
 - given clearer understanding of their duties and responsibilities
 - equipped with advanced skills on basic bookkeeping/record keeping allowing them to have a systematic financial records and financial statements
3. The association organized a lending institution and funded by the Department of Social Welfare and Development for them to start and sustain their business;

LESSONS LEARNED

1. Capiz State University-Burias Campus, being an institution of higher learning, plays a significant role in promoting human development in its immediate community.
2. Officers and members of the association, when given the chance to be more knowledgeable in terms of livelihood and entrepreneurship, can be more empowered and more driven in the portrayals of their roles and responsibilities in the community.
3. What goes around, comes around. What the Institution has provided to Burias is unconditionally paid back by the association and has become more supportive to the activity of CAPSU and vice versa, thus creating a mutual exchange of resources and assistance.
4. Knowing the fact that majority of the officers and members of the association have not attained higher degree of education, however their motivation to lead and to serve the association is beyond compared. There is an increasing demand to share the knowledge and skills in livelihood and entrepreneurship for them to channel their innate drive into something which is in accordance to what is expected from them to deliver.

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Since the College of Management of CAPSU Burias has drawn out positive results from the first component of the project, the College is now ready to extend the project to other barangays in the Municipality of Jamindan. Thus, the support and cooperation of the Local Government Unit of the mentioned municipality as well as the officials from other barangays should be solicited prior to widening its scope.
2. Constant monitoring by the College should be conducted to ensure the sustainability of the project.
3. 'Livelihood and Entrepreneurship Development Training Program' should be conducted by the College not only in the adopted barangay but also to other localities in town.
4. CAPSU should continuously assists the association to strengthen its capabilities and resources which in turn may be made into cooperative.